Name: _____ Date: _____

EVERYDAY COLONIAL LIFE

Work, worship, school, and neighbors

A normal day in the colonies

Just Listen Learning • Episode 7 • Just listen, together.

1. Who or What Am I?

Write the word from the box that matches each clue.

apprentice	indenture	journeyman	almanac
Sabbath	hornbook	frolic	militia

1. A young worker bound to learn a trade from a master _____
2. A signed paper promising years of work _____
3. A trained worker who could work for himself _____
4. A yearly book with a calendar, moon, tides, and weather _____
5. The Puritan day set apart for rest and worship _____
6. A wooden paddle used to learn the alphabet _____
7. A work party where neighbors helped each other _____
8. A citizen army made up of neighbors _____

2. Poster Time!

Draw a Frolic

Draw neighbors working together at a frolic: husking corn, raising a barn, or making a quilt. Then finish the sentence.

Our frolic: _____

3. Then and Now: True or False?

Read each sentence. Write T if it is true or F if it is false.

____ 1. Most colonial toys were bought in toy stores.

____ 2. Colonial children did not have to work until they were grown.

____ 3. Benjamin Franklin became an apprentice to his brother at age twelve.

____ 4. Indentured servants had to work for the rest of their lives.

____ 5. Everyone agreed that the Great Awakening was a good thing.

____ 6. Ben Franklin's almanac sold nearly ten thousand copies a year.

4. Think About It!

Answer in complete sentences.

1. How was a colonial child's day different from yours?

_____

_____

2. How was an apprentice's life different from an enslaved person's life?

_____

_____

5. Timeline

Number the events 1 to 5, earliest first.

- ☐ Ben Franklin's indenture
- ☐ Massachusetts reading law
- ☐ Poor Richard's Almanack begins
- ☐ Whitefield's preaching tour
- ☐ Silence Dogood letters

Ordinary weeks make a country.

Answer Key: Everyday Colonial Life

Just Listen Learning • Episode 7 • For parents and teachers

1. Who or What Am I?

1. apprentice
2. indenture
3. journeyman
4. almanac
5. Sabbath
6. hornbook
7. frolic
8. militia

2. Poster Time!

Drawings will vary. Look for a true detail from the story: neighbors husking corn, raising a house or barn, making a quilt, or plowing, and a good meal served by the host family, who later returned the favor.

3. Then and Now: True or False?

1. F (most toys were homemade, like cloth dolls, tops, and barrel hoops rolled with a stick)
2. F (children as young as five ran errands, fetched wood and water, and herded chickens)
3. T (he signed an indenture to work for his brother James, a printer in Boston, until age 21)
4. F (they worked about four to seven years for their passage, food, and a place to live, then went free)
5. F (some people loved the new, emotional preaching; others criticized it)
6. T (Poor Richard's Almanack, begun in 1732, was full of short, wise sayings)

4. Think About It!

1. Any true details: colonial children played leapfrog, hide-and-seek, and marbles, and had homemade toys like cloth dolls, tops, kites, and barrel hoops. They also worked from as young as five (errands, wood, water, chickens, weeding flax); girls sewed, baked, cared for younger children, and spun; boys worked in the fields, cared for animals, and carved spoons and bowls. School might be a dame school with a hornbook and the New England Primer, lessons at home, or a tutor on a Southern plantation.
2. An apprentice signed an indenture for a set number of years, learned a trade, got food, clothing, and a place to sleep, and at the end got new clothes and tools and became a journeyman. Enslaved Africans did many of the hardest jobs in fields and homes, were never paid, and were never free to leave.

5. Timeline

1. Massachusetts reading law (1642)
2. Ben Franklin's indenture (1718)
3. Silence Dogood letters (1722)
4. Poor Richard's Almanack begins (1732)
5. Whitefield's preaching tour (1739)

Box numbers as printed, top to bottom: 2, 1, 4, 5, 3

All drawings on this worksheet are original line art. Facts come from the Just Listen episode "Everyday Colonial Life".